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CASE 2 · CA DESIGN LAB

△ CASE

Personal finance advisor

Understanding my own money

How can an agent help people understand their money across all their accounts and apps, without selling them anything?

Many people spread their money across a current account, PayPal, a broker and more, and each app shows only its own slice. Bank apps categorise but rarely explain, personal advice is often tied to selling products, and general assistants state numbers with no calculation behind them. Nobody sees the whole picture, and a neutral explanation that respects the limits of financial advice is missing.

PRACTICE

- Transfers between your own accounts look like spending, and no app adds it all up.
- Under MiFID II and the German WpHG, recommending specific products is regulated advice.

RESEARCH

- People struggle to combine their own financial data (Lewis & Perry, 2019).
- Open tension: do users understand their money better, or do they simply rely on the agent?

USERS

- Students, first-job starters, households, hobby investors: your team picks one group.
- Last winter’s seminar: users want numbers with context, in euros and percent.

OPEN QUESTIONS

01 Why do people lose track of their money across apps?

02 When does an explanation build understanding, and when just reliance?

WHAT YOU GET

- Three synthetic personas with exports from several apps
- A starter repo for the agent
- Six core papers and about 40 further sources
- User insights from last winter’s project seminar



YOUR SUPERVISOR

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